



MONTHLY UPDATE

Niger: monthly update, August – September 2026

Edition of 2026-09-05 • 22 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH • GOVERNANCE • ICT INFRASTRUCTURE • DPI • TECHNOLOGY • CAPACITY • INCLUSION • DATA • GEOPOLITICS

Summary of the month

Identity ran through the month as an institution rather than a launch. The national registration and identification agency [is created by decree of 22 April 2026, with its statutes approved by a companion decree](#), and its awareness tour took the statutory texts to the regions “ Dosso on 14 August, then [Tillabéri as the third stop on 19 August](#)” while a technical mission [went to Burkina Faso to study its identification machinery](#).

The other thread is hardware and skills. The electronics assembly plant at Hamdallaye [was put at 63% complete and due in service by the end of October](#), a university at Diffa [opened the workshop validating its innovation hub's project document](#), and a digital-skills caravan [trained 140 young people at its Tahoua stage](#). A mobile operator launched an international transfer service on its money platform.

Governance

Legislation and regulation

The civil-status reforms are being explained rather than amended. The national awareness tour reached its fourth stage with [a workshop opening in Agadez on the civil-status and personal-identification reforms](#), where [the region mobilised its actors around inclusive governance of the new regime](#). Explaining a reform is not implementing it, and the record held carries no count of registrations made under the new regime in any region the tour has passed through.

Regional collaboration

On 30 July a Nigerien technical mission led by the interior ministry's secretary-general was [received in Ouagadougou to study Burkina Faso's identification machinery](#) — the civil-status modernisation directorate, the national identification office, the ICT agency and the WURI project. The delegation covered civil registration, migration, the digital agency, territorial surveillance, biometric-card production, the interior ministry's legal service and the ICT and finance ministries, and reported recommendations on issuing authentic documents and limiting document fraud.

Standards

The regulator's quality-of-service thresholds are not held. Its 2021 annual report [names the decision that sets them and what it does, but not its threshold values](#), and the regulator's own site does not surface the 2026 formal notices either. The standard the operators are being measured against cannot be read off the record, and neither, therefore, can the finding that they failed it.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

A state observatory monitored the country's media and platforms through a security incident and then told the media owners what it found. The national communication observatory [monitored traditional media, online media and the main publicly accessible digital platforms from 28 August to 1 September and presented its conclusions in Niamey on 2 September, reporting exceptional information intensity in the hours after shots and explosions were reported near an air base at the international airport, the effects of an information vacuum, divergence in how the facts were characterised, and social networks accelerating both information and disinformation with old images and out-of-context video circulated](#). Its president said the meeting was not a trial of the media. The monitoring report itself is not published, so what was measured, over what sample and under what legal basis is not established.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

On 27 July the telecommunications regulator [opened a second drive-test campaign over Niamey, running to 28 August 2026](#), to verify the corrective actions ordered after the April-May control found voice and mobile-data quality deficient at all four operators, with SMS alone compliant and one operator additionally below the 4G coverage thresholds.

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

The identification agency exists in law. It [was created by decree of 22 April 2026, with its statutes approved by a companion decree](#), and a national awareness tour is taking the civil-status and identification reforms to the regions, officially launched at Dosso on 14 August. No enrolment figure, budget or operating date for the agency is published, so what has moved is the instrument and not yet the register.

Digital Payments and Fintech

On 29 July the higher education minister said the grants agency reform consists of [acquiring database software and routing scholarship and social-aid payments through the banking system via the Treasury's application](#); no budget, vendor, timetable or beneficiary count was published.

The mobile-money issuer opened cross-border corridors. It [launched an international transfer service on 25 August, taking inbound transfers from eight countries directly into the recipient's wallet through five remittance partners and sending outbound transfers to seven West African states](#); no volume or fee schedule is published.

Registries

Three differently based birth-registration series are now on record and none is reconciled to another. The [WURI-Niger account records that 66% of births are declared](#); the territorial administration ministry [put the figure at 79% against 53.48% in 2022](#) at the launch of the population register's enrolment tour and restated it [at Dosso on 14 August](#); and the same ministry [gave 80% in 2026 against 60% in 2023](#) at the African civil-registration day five days earlier.

That day also produced the first count of how far registration has been computerised: UNICEF's Tahoua office said it had [contributed to computerising 68% of communes nationwide](#), and put the Tahoua region's own registration rate up from 69% to 75%, with four communes still uncovered. It is UNICEF's account of its own contribution; no ministry count is held.

The register's public campaign ran through the window. It [opened at Tahoua on 11 August](#) to make the governing legal texts and the intermediate enrolment operations known, and was [launched officially at Dosso on 14 August](#), where the interior ministry set out the statutory basis — ordonnance n°2026-21 on the civil-status regime, décret n°2026-242 creating the ANEI and décret n°2026-243 approving its statutes — and described the register as a central secure database assigning each citizen a unique identifier, interoperable with civil-status management, the biometric national card and travel documents.

Also on 29 July, the Diffa regional civil-status directorate reported [173,109 birth certificates issued between July 2023 and July 2026](#), of which 109,382 were timely declarations, with the timely rate rising from 56% in 2022 to 88.04% in 2025.

On 29 July the foreign minister closed the second diaspora forum by [undertaking to build a bank of priority diaspora projects and a data bank of diaspora experts](#); no enabling instrument, custodian, data-protection basis or timetable was named.

The population register's public campaign is running ahead of the register itself. A national civil-status and identification sensitisation tour [reached Tillabéri as its third region](#), with officials citing the 2026 civil-status ordinance and describing a forthcoming national population register whose first enrolment phase opens at Niamey ahead of a 2027 rollout to other regions. No enrolment target, budget, supplier or start date accompanies it, so the campaign precedes anything a citizen can yet enrol in.

Technology

ICT Industry

Hardware assembly is the one industrial position with a date attached. A government delegation inspecting the electronics plant at Hamdallaye [put it at 63 per cent complete and due in service by the end of October 2026, to assemble smartphones, computers and tablets](#). A completion percentage and a month are more than most rows in this report carry; what is absent is everything downstream of the building — capacity, cost, ownership and who buys the output.

Innovation ecosystem

The innovation estate gained a site and not yet a hub. A university at Diffa [was selected through a competitive process to host an innovation hub under a development-bank and UN-backed youth agripreneurship programme, and the workshop validating its project document opened](#). A project document at validation is the stage before a budget: none is published, and no opening date is set.

Capacity

Training and skills

Skills work travelled rather than sat still. The Niger Digital Day caravan [trained 140 young people at its Tahoua stage on 25 August](#), one leg of a programme its organisers say will run in all eight regions and reach more than 800 young people. Coverage and reach are the organisers' own figures and no completion or follow-up count is published, so the caravan is on record as a plan being executed rather than as a measured outcome.

Research institutions

The [Council of Ministers of 21 August 2026 took decisions on research and innovation](#). Cabinet conclusions name what is decided without carrying the text of it, so the base holds the announcement and not the instruments.

Inclusion

Access to services

A national digital-skills caravan reached the country's far east. About sixty young people [took part over two days in the university's computer room at Diffa, on training covering digital tools, occupations and opportunities](#). It is one stage of a caravan for which no national total, stage list, curriculum or funder is published.

Digital divides

One training cohort is the whole of the window's movement here. [500 women working in agri-food processing and pottery at Zinder completed a ten-day programme in business management, financial planning and the use of digital financial tools, run by a mobile operator's foundation as part of an effort it is extending across several countries](#). What is established is a completed cohort, not any change in the women's access to financial services: no follow-up, account-opening figure, cost or continuation is published.

Data

Use of satellite data

The national geographic institute [runs a remote-sensing unit producing Sentinel-based imagery for forest, land-use and territorial monitoring, and describes itself as an exclusive satellite-imagery distributor in several countries](#). No programme name, partner or date is published, and the page carries no date of its own, so the position is dated to retrieval rather than to any event.

Geopolitics

China activities

China's newly arrived ambassador [met the vendor's vice-president to discuss deepening cooperation](#). The vendor has operated in Niger since 1998 and a [2014 export-credit loan of RMB 623.7m built a 2,275 km domestic fibre backbone completed in 2017](#); no Chinese financing or vendor contract after 2017 is on record.

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